PHIONAH NAJJUMA

AI Engineer | Software Engineer | Python Backend Developer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI and software engineer focused on building, testing and deploying practical Python applications using Django and Flask. Skilled in backend development, REST APIs, relational databases, third-party AI and communication API integrations, debugging and software testing. Developed solutions for business operations, digital safety and legal-rights guidance, and inclusive AI-supported learning. Experienced in taking projects from problem definition through implementation, testing and deployment, with a strong commitment to continuous learning and collaborative engineering.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Certificate in Software Engineering | Refactory Academy | March 2026

Certificate in AI and Software Engineering (Python) | Turing College Academy | In progress

Uganda Advanced Certificate of Education (UACE) | Tropical High School, Kampala | 2023

Uganda Certificate of Education (UCE) | Tropical High School, Kampala | 2020

- Completed 240 hours of project-based software engineering training at Refactory Academy.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, SQL, JavaScript fundamentals

Backend & APIs: Django, Flask, Django ORM, REST APIs, webhooks, CRUD operations

Frontend: HTML5, CSS3, Bootstrap, Tailwind CSS

Databases: SQLite, relational data modelling, database migrations

AI & Integrations: Google Gemini API, Sunbird AI, prompt engineering, AI-enabled workflows, Africa's Talking APIs

Testing & Quality: Unit and integration testing, edge-case testing, debugging, root-cause analysis, input validation

Tools & Workflow: Git, GitHub, Linux, VS Code, Render, technical documentation

INTERPERSONAL SKILLS

Communication | Collaboration | Problem-solving | Adaptability | Independent learning | Attention to detail

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

BRIDGE — Digital Safety & Legal Rights Assistant | 2026

Python, Flask, SQLite, Google Gemini, Sunbird AI, Africa's Talking

- Built features for a multi-channel assistant providing digital-safety and legal-rights guidance through web, USSD, SMS and voice, with support designed for six languages.
- Integrated AI and communication services; implemented API and webhook workflows, bearer-token authentication, rate limiting and community-sourced scam-number screening.
- Created automated tests for communication channels, webhook behaviour, risk scoring and edge cases.

Project link: https://bridge-orib.onrender.com

NYONDO — Stock & Sales Management System | 2026

Python, Django, SQLite, Django ORM, HTML, CSS, Bootstrap

- Independently designed, developed and deployed a business application for inventory, sales, customers, suppliers, payments, expenses and reporting.
- Built relational data models and Django ORM workflows, including role-based access for administrators and staff.
- Implemented stock and payment workflows and debugged database migrations, model relationships and query issues.

Project link: https://nyondo-staock.onrender.com

DDIBA — AI Learning Companion | 2026

AI-enabled learning application

- Contributed to an AI-powered learning companion designed to make learning more accessible for students with dyslexia and other reading or learning differences.
- Worked on features intended to adapt learning material and its presentation to support reading, understanding and practice.

Project link: https://ddiba.onrender.com

Event Management & Communication Platform | Hackathon project

Africa's Talking APIs, USSD and SMS workflows

- Collaborated on an event-management solution supporting communication between organisers and participants, including feedback collection.
- Contributed to a USSD-based approach that allowed people without smartphones to participate; the team won first place at an Africa's Talking hackathon.